Day 56 (stop 1 of 2) - Wilson Homestead, Avalanche Pass, Vanishing Wall

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Sydenham section · hike 71 · Silent Valley Nature Reserve

5.9 km / 3.7 mi	~1.9 h	3.0 km new	143 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

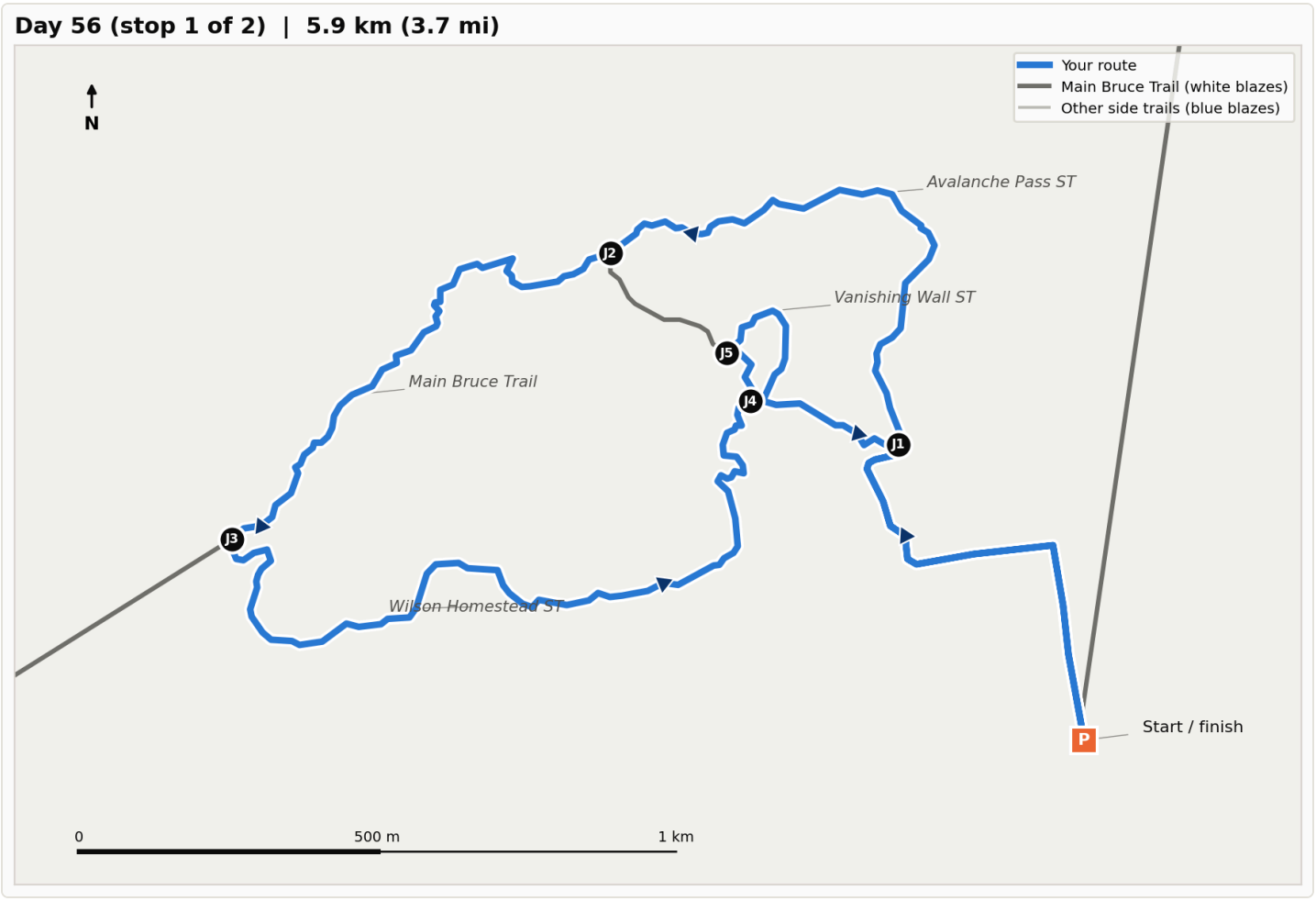
Park (P): Roadside parking at the north end of 2nd Concession S, providing access to the Silent Valley Side Trail. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day56a_hike071.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Wilson Homestead Side Trail (1.6 km); Avalanche Pass Side Trail (1.1 km); Vanishing Wall Side Trail (0.3 km)

Same day: this is stop 1 of 2 on day 56 (7.1 mi of hiking, about 294 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 2: hike 72, 3.4 mi from Woodford Parking.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** Limited roadside parking at the north end of 2nd Concession S, off Grey Rd 18 near Bognor. The Silent Valley Side Trail leads in from there.
- **Silent Valley:** A 200-acre Bruce Trail Conservancy reserve with wetland, reforested farmland, old cedar and hardwood forest, and a stretch of the Niagara Escarpment. The club rates its loop moderate to strenuous, with steep, rocky escarpment sections and large tumbled dolostone.
- **Main Trail & Avalanche Pass:** The Main Trail runs along the top of the escarpment. The Avalanche side trail explores the talus slope below it. Both are described as the more challenging trails here, so expect rocky, uneven footing.
- **Vanishing Wall Side Trail:** A short spur. We found no published description of it.
- **Wilson Homestead Side Trail:** The easy part of the walk. It passes the stone foundation of a settler's barn with fossils in its walls, a stone-lined well about 20 ft deep and the wreckage of a Cessna that crashed in a 1970 storm, now a memorial with a plaque. Keep Zappy well back from the open well.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: Roadside parking at the north end of 2nd Concession S, providing access to the Silent.... Walk about 30 m to the trail. Head north on the white-blazed main Bruce Trail. The next 0.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
0.8	0.5	J1: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Avalanche Pass Side Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
1.9	1.2	J2: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading west. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.)
2.9	1.8	J3: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Wilson Homestead Side Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
4.4	2.7	J4: Turn left onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading north. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your right.)
4.5	2.8	J5: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Vanishing Wall Side Trail, heading north-east. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off ahead.)
4.8	3.0	J4: Continue straight onto the white-blazed main Bruce Trail, heading south. (the white-blazed main Bruce Trail goes off on your left.) Then, turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
4.9	3.0	J4: Junction. Turn right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading east. (the Vanishing Wall Side Trail you already walked goes off ahead.)
5.1	3.2	J1: Junction. Turn sharp right to stay on the main Bruce Trail, heading south-west. (the Avalanche Pass Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
5.4	3.3	Heads-up: The next 0.6 km follows an unopened road allowance (rough track, no traffic).
5.9	3.7	Leave the trail and walk back to the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on the Sydenham Bruce Trail Club, The Meaford Independent and MilitaryBruce.